

TEMPTATION

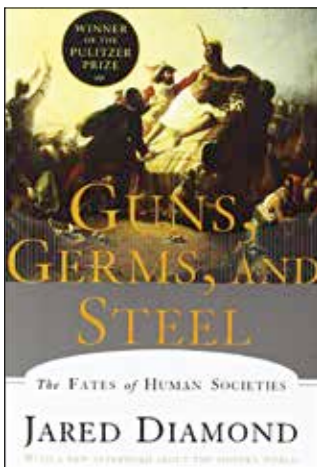
CRITIQUE

In this section, we put stuff through the grinder and closely examine what comes out; everything except gadgets, because there's more to life than just that

BOOK REVIEW

Guns, Germs, and Steel

Things that shaped the modern world



Throughout history if there is one thing we've seen repeated over and over, it's that whenever a superior technologically advanced civilisation comes in contact with a primitive one, the latter usually finds itself subjugated or exterminated. Without delving into the moralistic analysis of why this happens, a more interesting question to tackle is figuring out how some human societies

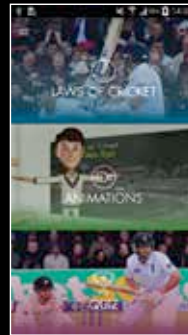
develop distinct technological advantages over others. Why, for example, did European nations develop guns and other technologies and those of say the far east or the new world, or Africa, did not? Why were did Native Americans die from European diseases and not vice versa? These are some of the questions Jared Diamond tries to answer by analysing the trajectories of early human societies from the very dawn of civilisation around 13000 years ago. Food production, animal domestication, geography, development of the written word and a few other surprising factors hold the key to unravelling these questions. Although this book is not as breezy as A Brief History Of Everything it is every bit as informative and worth picking up for anyone even remotely interested in technology, history and the evolution of human societies.

Rating: ★★★★★

– Siddharth Parwatay

APP WATCH

Laws of Cricket

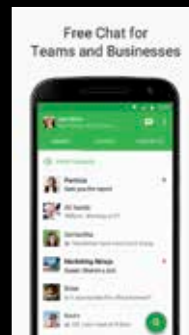


Locally, it's almost blasphemous not to like or follow cricket. If you're among the fringe minority who genuinely wants to follow the sheeple and learn about the gentleman's sport, there's an app for that. The Marylebone Cricket Club that owns the Lord's Cricket Stadium has released the Laws of Cricket app, aiming to broadcast the rules and laws of the game to everyone. The laws are categorised in eight sections covering every aspect of the game. Few of them, 15 to be specific, have been narrated by writer and actor, Stephen Fry. There are additionally 18 videos to explain the umpire's gestures in the game.

App Store: <http://dgit.in/LoCiOS>

Play Store: <http://dgit.in/LoCAnd>

Flock



Several workplace chat applications have been flooding the market. Such group chat applications aim to facilitate better communication within the team using the in-built features such as file sharing, video conference calls etc. Flock is the new kid on the block who is trying to take on the big players such as Slack, Asana and the recent, Facebook at Work. Although it doesn't try to overdo with a horde of features, the UI is kept simple similar to WhatsApp, keeping the feel closer to an IM application. Flock is a multi-platform tool so your team members can communicate with the team from any device out there.

App Store: <http://dgit.in/FlockiOS>

Play Store: <http://dgit.in/FlockAnd>

Windows Store: <http://dgit.in/FlockWin>

Fitastik



Fitastik analyses all the medical records and data fed by you into their system and accordingly, classifies them into different sections. The graphs and charts will ensure that you don't get muddled by the deluge of numbers present in your medical records. The graphs also serve as a health monitoring system for you and your family members. All these features are available for free but if you wish to have unlimited conversion of medical records to a digital form, or receive health analysis, you have to opt for their paid membership.

App Store: <http://dgit.in/FitastikiOS>

Play Store: <http://dgit.in/FitastikAnd>